

Some practical issues

- Who are the users?
- What do we mean by 'needs'?
- How to generate alternatives
- How to choose among alternatives
- How to integrate interaction design activities with other lifecycle models?

Who are the users/stakeholders?

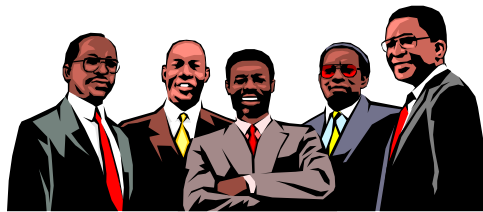
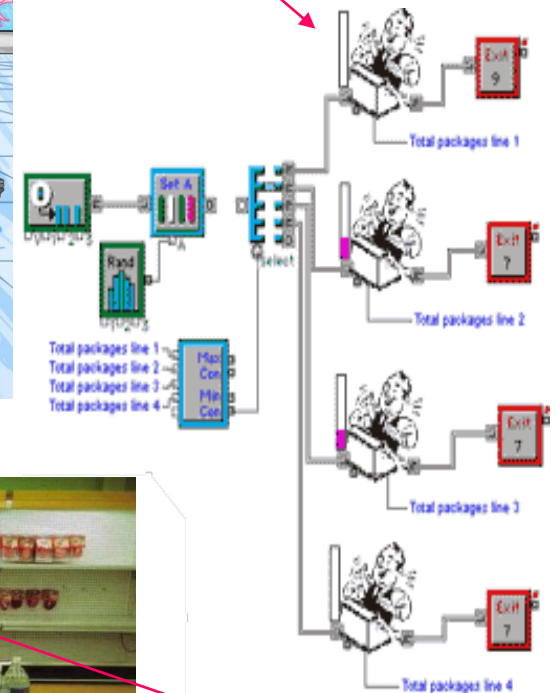
- Not as obvious as you think:
 - those who interact directly with the product
 - those who manage direct users
 - those who receive output from the product
 - those who make the purchasing decision
 - those who use competitor's products
- Three categories of user (Eason, 1987):
 - primary: frequent hands-on
 - secondary: occasional or via someone else
 - tertiary: affected by its introduction, or will influence its purchase

Who are the stakeholders?

- Suppliers
- Local shop owners



Check-out operators



Managers and owners



Customers

What do we mean by ‘needs’ ?

- Users rarely know what is possible
- Users can't tell you what they ‘need’ to help them achieve their goals
- Instead, look at existing tasks:
 - their context
 - what information do they require?
 - who collaborates to achieve the task?
 - why is the task achieved the way it is?
- Envisioned tasks:
 - can be rooted in existing behaviour
 - can be described as future scenarios